
IMESI

International Mutual Economic Security Instrument

Red Team Scenarios

12 Adversarial Stress-Test Exercises

Version 10.0

March 2026

For use in tabletop exercises, institutional stress-testing,
and Founding Conference preparation

REFERENCE ARCHITECTURE — RESTRICTED DISTRIBUTION

INTRODUCTION

This document contains 12 adversarial stress-test scenarios designed to test IMESI v10.0 against sophisticated, real-world attack vectors. Each scenario is built to exploit specific provisions and identify institutional failure modes before an adversary does.

The scenarios are organised into four threat categories: Digital and Financial Coercion (Scenarios 1, 7, 12), Intensity and Speed Attacks (Scenarios 2, 8), Political Fragmentation and Solidarity (Scenarios 3, 9, 11), and Compound and Hybrid Threats (Scenarios 4, 5, 6, 10). Each includes: the crisis inject, the specific IMESI provisions under test, success metrics, documented failure modes, and a decision-point worksheet for exercise participants.

Operating Principles: The red team operates with full knowledge of IMESI architecture and designs exploits specifically against documented safeguards. Scenarios may simulate behaviour violating international law to test defensive response boundaries. Each exercise includes a mandatory 30-day lessons-learned integration into the scenario library (Section 4.6I).

HOW TO USE THESE SCENARIOS

- The Inject: The initial crisis news alert that participants receive.
- The Technical Challenge: Which specific provisions of IMESI v10.0 apply and how they interact.
- The Decision Point: A worksheet for sherpas/officials to decide: what do we trigger now, what do we wait on?
- Success Metrics: Measurable outcomes that define whether IMESI survived the test.
- Failure Modes: Documented ways the system could break, for post-exercise remediation.

CROSS-CUTTING ASSESSMENT FRAMEWORK

For all 12 scenarios, evaluate against these common stress indicators:

- Detection-to-Response Latency: >6 hours for financial stability threats → automatic IAC review of IEWC protocols.
- Coalition Defection Rate: >2 members per case → DCCB activation; hibernation protocol assessment.
- False Positive Rate: >20% over 12-month period → ADAI suspension; mandatory external audit.
- Public Legitimacy Score: <50% support in 3+ member states → mandatory democratic legitimacy review.
- Fund Liquidity Draw: >30% of paid-in base in 30 days → emergency capital call; IMF/BIS facility activation.

SCENARIO 1

"THE DIGITAL GHOST"

Testing Digital-Only Coercion Coverage

THE INJECT

A major regional power (State X) suddenly excludes a mid-sized IMESI Member (State Y) from a multilateral CBDC bridge used for 40% of State Y's regional trade settlement. State X claims this is a "routine technical upgrade." No tariffs are raised. SWIFT access remains untouched. All conventional indicators are green.

THE TWIST

The coercion is invisible to legacy monitoring systems. The only signals are settlement delays and wallet-level throttling inside a closed proprietary system. State X has designed the exclusion to fall outside every traditional trade-coercion indicator.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can the IEWC certify this as coercion without a "smoking gun" diplomatic memo? Can IMESI respond when legacy systems show nothing wrong?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 2.0B: Digital-Only Coercion Coverage — does "irrespective of technological channel" actually work in practice?
- Section 2.10+: Amber-Stage Digital Channel Mapping — was State Y's exposure mapped before the crisis?
- Section 8.10Y: Liquidity Pre-Positioning — can standby facilities deploy through alternative channels?
- Section 8.10Z: Digital Payment Resilience Playbooks — does State Y have a contingency plan for CBDC exclusion?
- Section 5.0N: Flash Stabilisation — can Phase 0 activate when the choke point is a proprietary CBDC, not a bank?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Do we trigger Amber Status based on digital settlement anomalies alone, before conventional trade data confirms the impact?
- Do we activate Flash Stabilisation for a "technical" disruption that hasn't yet been certified as coercion?
- How do we explain to markets and parliaments that this is coercion when SWIFT is functioning normally?
- Do we deploy alternative settlement routes now (accepting cost) or wait for IEWC certification (risking delay)?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ IEWC certifies within 72 hours using digital transaction pattern evidence, without requiring diplomatic "smoking gun"
- ✓ Amber Digital Mapping identifies at least 2 feasible fallback settlement routes within 24 hours
- ✓ Flash Stabilisation activates Phase 0 liquidity through alternative channels within 6 hours of Chair + 2 concurrence
- ✓ State Y's trade settlement continuity maintained at >80% of normal volume within 7 days

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ IEWC analysts trained on conventional trade data cannot interpret CBDC transaction logs; certification delayed >7 days
- ✗ No pre-mapped digital fallback exists because Amber Digital Mapping was never conducted for State Y
- ✗ Flash Stabilisation pre-positioned instruments are denominated in legacy currencies unusable in the CBDC ecosystem
- ✗ Market communications fail: media reports "no coercion detected" because SWIFT indicators are normal

Primary References: Sections 2.0B, 2.10+, 5.0N, 8.10Y, 8.10Z

SCENARIO 2

"THE 30-DAY BLITZ"

Testing Intensity-Compressed Coercion and Flash Response

THE INJECT

An aggressor state imposes a massive 200% "Environmental Surcharge" on a critical mineral exported to an IMESI member. They explicitly state the surcharge will be removed in exactly 31 days if a specific piece of domestic legislation is repealed. The target member's manufacturing sector faces immediate shutdown — 90% of its rare-earth supply comes from this source.

THE TWIST

The aggressor knows that standard international bodies take 60-90 days to deliberate. They intend to break the target's industry before a full CC vote can be scheduled. The 31-day window is deliberately calibrated to fall just outside IMESI's standard review cycles.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can the target survive the first week without a total market collapse? Can IMESI respond faster than the aggressor's 31-day deadline?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 2.10A: Intensity-Compressed Coercion (>0.2% GDP in 30 days) — does this trigger fast enough?
- Section 5.0N: Flash Stabilisation — can the Secretariat activate Phase 0 within 6 hours?
- Section 8.10Y/8.10+: Pre-Positioning — does pre-positioned liquidity actually move fast enough to calm markets?
- Section 5.0J: Standard Response Templates — does a "critical import disruption" template exist and is it usable?
- Section 4.3D: Impact & Deterrence Note — after the crisis ends, can IMESI credibly signal that a repeat will be costlier?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Do we activate Flash Stabilisation immediately (6-hour window) or wait for full IEWC certification (48-72 hours)?
- Do we deploy the "critical import disruption" Response Template or design a bespoke package?
- The coercer lifts measures on Day 31 as promised — do we still complete the case, or does it die in committee?
- How do we maintain deterrent credibility after a "brief squeeze" that technically resolved itself?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Flash Stabilisation Phase 0 activated within 6 hours of initial surcharge announcement
- ✓ Pre-positioned liquidity deployed to target's central bank within 12 hours
- ✓ Joint Procurement sources alternative rare-earth supply commitments within 5 days
- ✓ Case fully documented and archived with published Deterrence Note even after coercer lifts measures
- ✓ Target member's manufacturing sector operates at >70% capacity throughout the 31-day period

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Flash Stabilisation requires Chair + 2 CC members from different regions; cannot reach all three within 6 hours due to time zones
- ✗ Pre-positioned liquidity is insufficient for rare-earth procurement (instruments designed for currency stabilisation, not commodity purchase)
- ✗ Coercer lifts measures on Day 31; political pressure within CC to "move on" prevents case documentation
- ✗ Standard Response Template for "critical import disruption" specifies tariff responses, but the target imports very little from the coercer — no leverage

Primary References: Sections 2.10A, 5.0J, 5.0N, 8.10Y, 8.10+, 4.3D

SCENARIO 3

"THE SOVEREIGNTY WEDGE"

Testing Political Solidarity and Defection Resistance

THE INJECT

A global superpower threatens to sanction any IMESI member that participates in a collective Phase 1 response against a third-party state. It specifically targets the "Low-Exposure" members (0.15% GDP ceiling), offering them exclusive bilateral trade deals worth 2-3x their annual IMESI contributions if they invoke their Managed Adjustment Option to opt out of the collective response.

THE TWIST

The superpower's intelligence services have identified which IMESI members have upcoming elections, which finance ministers are under domestic fiscal pressure, and which parliaments have the weakest commitment to IMESI. They tailor individual offers to each vulnerable member's specific political pain points.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Does the coalition fracture, or do the solidarity mechanisms hold? Does the Low-Exposure track make members safer or make them the "weakest link" for an aggressor to target?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 8.0D: Low-Exposure Contribution Profile — does the 0.15% ceiling create a targetable vulnerability class?
- Section 7.4B: Managed Adjustment Option — can it be mass-invoked to effectively gut a response?
- Section 6.4B: Transparency Ledger — do members notify these bilateral "offers" within 10 days?
- Section 6.7A: Contained Non-Participation Protocol — does automatic burden rebalancing keep the response viable?
- Section 3.2D: Accession Impact Notes — can these keep domestic parliaments committed during the crisis?
- Section 5.0+: Non-Escalatory Framing — does it provide diplomatic cover for smaller members to stay?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- A Low-Exposure member's finance minister calls: "We can't afford the surcharge from Managed Adjustment, but we can't afford to participate either." What do you offer them?
- Three members simultaneously invoke Managed Adjustment — does the response still meet minimum viable intensity?
- The coercer's bilateral offer is genuine and economically attractive — is "IMESI solidarity" enough to compete with hard cash?
- Do we publicly name the coercer's pressure campaign (risking escalation) or handle it confidentially (risking members feeling unsupported)?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ No more than 2 members invoke Managed Adjustment in the same case
- ✓ Transparency Ledger notifications filed by all members receiving bilateral offers within 10 days
- ✓ Contained Non-Participation rebalancing keeps response at >60% of planned intensity
- ✓ Domestic parliaments in targeted states vote to maintain participation after receiving Accession Impact briefings
- ✓ Coalition publicly demonstrates unity within 14 days of the coercer's pressure campaign

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Managed Adjustment Option is invoked by 4+ members simultaneously, effectively gutting the Phase 1 package below minimum viable intensity
- ✗ Transparency Ledger notifications are filed late (>10 days) or not at all because bilateral offers were made verbally with no paper trail
- ✗ Low-Exposure members feel the 0.15% ceiling provides insufficient protection and seek bilateral exit arrangements outside IMESI channels
- ✗ Accession Impact Notes arrive too late to influence parliamentary debate; opposition has already framed the narrative
- ✗ "Quiet Failure" via Managed Adjustment becomes the norm; 40% of members routinely opt out, creating a two-tier coalition

Primary References: Sections 3.2D, 5.0+, 6.4B, 6.7A, 7.4B, 8.0D

SCENARIO 4

"THE TROJAN EXEMPTION"

Testing Anti-Fragmentation Under Stealth Bilateralism

THE INJECT

A systemic economy (GDP >15% global) with sophisticated economic statecraft capabilities targets a Tier 2 member with high bilateral trade dependence (35% of GDP) and upcoming elections in 8 months. The coercer offers a "technical compliance pathway" — publicly maintaining pressure while privately offering: 18-month tariff exemptions for sectors tied to the ruling party's electoral base, infrastructure investment contingent on "procedural delays" in IMESI implementation, and personal commercial benefits to key decision-makers via opaque family-linked entities.

THE TWIST

The coercer has studied IMESI's detection thresholds and designed its approach to stay below each one: the tariff exemption is structured as "routine preferential treatment," the investment is through a multilateral development bank (not bilateral), and the personal benefits flow through three layers of corporate shells.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI detect pre-contractual negotiations before formal agreement? Can the ACE trigger on trade-flow anomalies after an informal deal is struck? Do evidentiary standards for corruption-linked defection actually work?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 6.4B: Transparency Ledger — does "10-day notification" catch verbal/informal offers?
- Section 6.3: ACE (Amended) — does it trigger on trade-flow anomalies before formal bilateral announcement?
- Section 6.1(h): Corrupt Inducements — can family-linked entity benefits be traced to IMESI-related decisions?
- Section 6.11/6.11(d): Misconduct — do evidentiary standards sustain suspension for corruption-linked defection?
- Section 6.7A: Contained Non-Participation — does it activate when defection is isolated but from a major member?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- The target member's trade flows show a 12% shift toward the coercer over 3 months — is this evidence of a secret deal or routine market dynamics?
- Do we trigger ACE (24-hour timeline) based on circumstantial evidence, risking a false positive that damages business confidence?
- The target member's government denies any deal and invokes sovereignty — how far do we push the investigation?
- If corruption is confirmed, do we pursue suspension (75% CC vote) or accept the Managed Adjustment pathway to keep the member in the coalition?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ IEWC detects anomalous diplomatic/trade pattern within 72 hours of first informal contact
- ✓ ACE triggers before formal bilateral announcement
- ✓ IAC evidentiary review sustains suspension under Section 6.11 if corruption confirmed
- ✓ Coalition cohesion maintained without >2 additional defections

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ False negative: IEWC misses signal due to "constructive ambiguity" in diplomatic language
- ✗ False positive: ACE triggers on legitimate commercial negotiation, damaging business confidence and trust in IMESI
- ✗ Delayed escalation: 14-day investigation window allows coercer to accelerate offer before detection
- ✗ Evidentiary gap: family-linked entities are legally separate; Section 6.1(h) "politically exposed person" standard doesn't reach third-tier shell companies
- ✗ Political paralysis: CC members reluctant to vote 75% for suspension against a major economy they depend on commercially

Primary References: Sections 6.1(h), 6.3, 6.4B, 6.7A, 6.11, 6.11(d)

SCENARIO 5

"THE SYNTHETIC CASCADE"

Testing Cognitive Coercion and AI-Generated Economic Chaos

THE INJECT

A state with advanced AI capabilities launches a coordinated synthetic attack against a Tier 3 member with a concentrated financial sector: (1) deepfake video of the target's central bank governor announcing "IMESI exit under consideration" released 30 minutes before market open; (2) AI-generated "leaked IEWC assessment" showing 40% Fund insolvency probability circulated to financial journalists; (3) algorithmic trading bots (state-affiliated via shell entities) amplify volatility in target's sovereign debt and currency; (4) authentic-looking "insider" social media posts from verified opposition politician accounts confirming "coalition fracture imminent."

THE TWIST

The attack mixes synthetic and authentic signals. Some opposition politicians genuinely are sceptical of IMESI — their real statements are amplified alongside fabricated ones. The deepfake is technically excellent (confidence score manipulation designed to suppress automated detection below 85% threshold). The "leaked assessment" contains enough real data points from public sources to appear credible.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can Section 2.9 (Cognitive Coercion) detection work when synthetic and authentic signals are deliberately intermixed? Can Track A stabilisation deploy before market panic becomes self-fulfilling?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 2.9: Cognitive Coercion — detection thresholds under synthetic/authentic signal mixing
- Section 2.9+: Strict Scope Limitation — how do you combat fabricated content without censoring genuine political debate?
- Section 5.0F: Dual-Track Response — can Track A stabilisation outpace market panic?
- Section 4.2U: RLSM — can the Legitimacy Panel issue a credible counter-signal within 72 hours?
- Annex 16+: IMESI-Targeted Disinformation — collective fact-based response vs. "Narrative Neutrality" constraint

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- The deepfake is circulating and markets are falling — do we issue a public denial (confirming we're aware of the attack) or handle it quietly (risking further spread)?
- Opposition politicians' genuine scepticism is being amplified alongside fabricated content — how do we counter the fakes without appearing to suppress legitimate political speech?
- Track A liquidity is deployed but markets continue falling because the "IEWC insolvency" narrative is more compelling than our stabilisation numbers — do we escalate to extraordinary public disclosure of Fund solvency data?
- The attack is traced to state-affiliated bots — does this constitute coercion sufficient for Phase 1, or just "information operations"?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Synthetic content flagged within 15 minutes of release
- ✓ Coordinated trading halt recommendations issued within 1 hour
- ✓ Track A liquidity prevents >5% currency depreciation in first 4 hours
- ✓ Collective fact-based communication response published within 6 hours without violating Narrative Neutrality Rule
- ✓ Coercion Forecast Market manipulation detected; false "coalition credibility collapse" narrative contained

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Confidence score artificially suppressed below 85% via adversarial perturbation; automated detection fails
- ✗ Human confirmation delay (4-hour window) allows market panic to exceed stabilisation capacity
- ✗ Participants in Coercion Forecast Market front-run or amplify false signals for profit, creating genuine liquidity crisis from synthetic information
- ✗ "Cry wolf" effect: repeated activations for synthetic threats reduce market responsiveness to genuine crises
- ✗ Strict Scope Limitation (Section 2.9+) prevents response to fabricated opposition statements that are technically "political discourse"

Primary References: Sections 2.9, 2.9+, 4.2U, 5.0F, Annex 16+

SCENARIO 6

"THE CLIMATE-SHOCK COERCION"

Testing Compound Emergency Under Environmental-Economic Hybrid Warfare

THE INJECT

A major agricultural exporter with a climate-adaptive technology monopoly targets 4 small-state IMESI Members simultaneously facing: (1) a UNFCCC-certified Category 4 hurricane causing 8% GDP damage to 2 members; (2) simultaneous "temporary export restriction" on drought-resistant seed variants, citing "domestic food security needs"; (3) documented private diplomatic communications linking seed access to "reconsideration of climate litigation" against the coercer. The coercer offers bilateral "humanitarian exception" to 2 of 4 affected states contingent on non-participation in joint IMESI response.

THE TWIST

The coercer's "domestic food security" claim has superficial legitimacy — they are experiencing drought conditions. The humanitarian exception offer splits the small-state cluster: 2 states face immediate famine risk and are tempted to accept bilateral terms to secure seed supply. The compound emergency (climate + coercion) strains the Multi-Crisis Stress Envelope in ways not modelled in the standard scenarios.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI handle the simultaneous intersection of natural disaster and deliberate coercion without the climate crisis providing cover for the economic attack?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 1.6: Compound Emergency — automatic adjustments when climate and coercion coincide
- Section 2.1C: Small-State Aggregation — does consolidation of 4 cases trigger automatically?
- Section 5.0B: Small-State First Activation — Phase 0+ to all 4 states within 24 hours?
- Section 8.4E: Multi-Crisis Stress Envelope — prioritisation under concurrent climate-coercion demands
- Section 2.7+: Climate Non-Adjudication — does the coercer's "food security" claim create a grey zone?
- Section 6.4B: Transparency Ledger — do the 2 states notify the bilateral "humanitarian exception" offer?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Two small states face famine risk and the coercer is offering seeds — do we tell them to refuse humanitarian aid for solidarity?
- The coercer's "domestic food security" claim is partially legitimate — do we certify coercion or call it a grey zone?
- Multi-Crisis Envelope is being drawn down by the climate response — do we prioritise hurricane relief or coercion response?
- The 2 states accept the bilateral offer before we can activate — does this fragment the small-state cluster beyond repair?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Compound Emergency triggers within 6 hours of dual certification (climate + coercion)
- ✓ Small-State First Activation deploys Phase 0+ to all 4 states within 24 hours
- ✓ Multi-Crisis prioritisation correctly sequences: humanitarian > small-state protection > chronological
- ✓ At least 3 of 4 affected states maintain coalition participation
- ✓ Alternative seed supply sourced through Joint Procurement within 10 days

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ IEWC delays coercion certification pending climate damage assessment, exceeding 72-hour window for irreversible harm
- ✗ Burden-sharing shifts to pure GDP basis, disadvantaging small states with low GDP but high climate vulnerability
- ✗ Coercer's "humanitarian exception" offer accepted by 2 states before coalition can expand; cluster fragments
- ✗ Climate Non-Adjudication clause creates ambiguity: is the seed restriction "coercive" or "legitimate food security policy"?
- ✗ Fund liquidity fully committed to climate relief; no capacity remaining for coercion response

Primary References: Sections 1.6, 2.1C, 2.7+, 5.0B, 6.4B, 8.4E

SCENARIO 7

"THE CLOSED LOOP"

Testing Coercion Inside Alternative CBDC/mBridge Systems

THE INJECT

A systemic non-member launches a regional CBDC platform used for a large share of energy and critical-minerals trade among a group of IMESI members. After a public dispute over export controls, it quietly begins: selective CBDC wallet throttling for the most exposed IMESI member's energy companies; slowing settlement for that member's import payments by 3-5 days; and "technical issues" affecting only that member's transactions. All of this happens entirely inside the alternative system; dollar, euro, SWIFT, and legacy banking channels look completely normal.

THE TWIST

The coercer has designed the platform with no independent audit capability — IMESI cannot directly verify transaction logs. The only evidence is statistical: the affected member's settlement times have tripled while other users' remain normal. The coercer attributes this to "network congestion" and offers "premium tier" access for a fee.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI detect, certify, and respond to coercion happening entirely inside a system it has no technical access to, using only indirect evidence?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 2.0B: Digital-Only Coverage — can certification proceed on statistical/circumstantial evidence alone?
- Section 2.10+: Amber Digital Mapping — was the CBDC dependency mapped before the crisis?
- Section 2.15: Evidentiary Standards — are settlement-time anomalies sufficient without direct transaction log access?
- Section 8.10Z: Digital Payment Playbooks — does a fallback exist for this specific platform?
- Section 5.0N: Flash Stabilisation — can Phase 0 work when the choke point is a proprietary foreign platform?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- We have statistical evidence but no direct proof — do we certify coercion based on inference?
- The coercer offers "premium access" at a price — do we pay to restore service, or refuse on principle?
- Other IMESI members using the same platform are not affected — they resist calling it "coercion" because they don't want to jeopardise their own access. How do we build consensus?
- Do we publicly name the platform as a coercion vector, risking that other members exit it voluntarily (causing self-harm)?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ IEWC certifies based on statistical pattern evidence within 72 hours
- ✓ At least 2 alternative settlement routes operational within 7 days
- ✓ Affected member's energy imports continue at >75% of normal volume
- ✓ Coalition consensus maintained: platform identified as coercion vector without triggering panic exit by other users

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ IEWC cannot certify without direct transaction evidence; statistical inference deemed insufficient under Section 2.15
- ✗ No alternative settlement route exists for the specific commodity (energy) settled on this platform
- ✗ Other IMESI members on the same platform vote against certification to protect their own access
- ✗ Affected member pays "premium access" fee under duress, setting precedent that digital extortion works

Primary References: Sections 2.0B, 2.10+, 2.15, 5.0N, 8.10Z

SCENARIO 8

"THE BLITZ VANISHES"

Testing Post-Crisis Documentation and Deterrence Credibility

THE INJECT

A large non-member announces sudden "technical standards" revisions for key imports from one IMESI member, effective in 7 days: suspended import licences for autos and electronics, arbitrary inspection regimes stalling goods at ports, and public messaging openly linking rollback to a specific policy demand. The measures hit hard for 30 days (trade drop >25% in affected sectors) then are abruptly lifted once political concessions are refused.

THE TWIST

The coercer lifts measures on Day 31 as promised, then publicly declares the dispute "resolved through dialogue." It pressures IMESI members to drop the case: "the crisis is over, why are you still escalating?" Domestic media in the target country echoes this framing. The coercer calculates that IMESI cannot maintain political will for documentation and deterrence after the immediate pain has passed.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI complete case documentation, publish a credible Deterrence Note, and maintain the institutional record after the coercer has already backed off? Or does political pressure to "move on" kill accountability?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 2.10A: Intensity-Compressed Coercion — does the clause work retroactively for documentation?
- Section 2.10D: Pattern-Adaptive Assessment — can it flag this as part of a "test and retreat" pattern?
- Section 4.3D: Impact & Deterrence Note — can the Secretariat publish a credible note after the crisis has ended?
- Section 5.0G: Harmonised Reviews — does the 30-day First Check still trigger when measures have already been lifted?
- Section 4.3B+: Public Case Summary — does the Legitimacy Dashboard record this as a case even without Phase 2+ escalation?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- The coercer has backed off and the target is recovering — do we complete the case or close it?
- Other CC members want to "move on" to preserve relations with the coercer — how do we maintain institutional discipline?
- The Deterrence Note will publicly document the coercer's behaviour — the coercer threatens "consequences" if published. Do we publish?
- This is the second "test and retreat" by the same coercer in 3 years — do we invoke Pattern-Adaptive Assessment and the Repeat Coercer Presumption?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Case fully documented and archived in Dashboard within 14 days of measures lifting
- ✓ Impact & Deterrence Note published within 30 days, including estimated costs to both sides
- ✓ Pattern-Adaptive Assessment flags this as part of a "test and retreat" series
- ✓ Repeat Coercer Presumption activated for future cases from the same source
- ✓ Institutional record maintained: future analysts can reference this case in threat assessments

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Political pressure within CC to "move on" prevents case documentation; no institutional record created
- ✗ Deterrence Note delayed >90 days and eventually published in watered-down form that omits key details
- ✗ Pattern-Adaptive Assessment not triggered because each individual episode is treated as resolved
- ✗ Target member's government itself requests case closure to preserve bilateral relationship; IMESI compliance blocked
- ✗ Coercer learns that "brief squeeze" tactics work with impunity and escalates to more aggressive patterns

Primary References: Sections 2.10A, 2.10D, 4.3B+, 4.3D, 5.0G

SCENARIO 9

"PARLIAMENT BLINKS"

Testing Ratification Defence and Domestic Political Resilience

THE INJECT

A mid-sized founding state has ratified IMESI but not yet fully implemented contribution legislation. It faces a domestic recession, fiscal consolidation, and an election in 9 months. A coercive non-member offers a bilateral trade and investment package explicitly conditioned on "reconsidering participation in certain multilateral economic security schemes." Simultaneously, funded media and lobbying campaigns paint IMESI as an expensive "GDP-tax" imposed by foreign bureaucrats.

THE TWIST

As a Moderate-severity coercion case against another IMESI member heats up, this state's parliament delays authorising its contribution, opens an inquiry into "fiscal exposure" from IMESI, and floats a motion to suspend participation. The opposition leader is briefed by the coercer's ambassador. Three major business associations publish open letters calling for IMESI withdrawal.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI's domestic support tools outpace a well-funded, professionally executed narrative attack timed to an election cycle?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 3.2D: Accession Impact Note — can the Secretariat produce a credible, non-partisan fiscal note fast enough?
- Section 7.4B: Managed Adjustment — can the state temporarily down-shift obligations without breaking trust?
- Section 6.7A: Contained Non-Participation — can the coalition rebalance while this member's parliament deliberates?
- Section 4.3B+: Public Case Summary / Legitimacy Dashboard — do public-facing legitimacy tools neutralise the "GDP-tax" narrative?
- Section 6.4B: Transparency Ledger — is the bilateral offer notified?
- Section 3.1I: Accession-Linked Coercion Support — does the media/lobbying campaign constitute "coercion linked to IMESI participation"?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Parliament is 48 hours from a vote to suspend participation — can the Secretariat deliver a briefing pack in time?
- The state invokes Managed Adjustment for the active case — do we accept gracefully or push back?
- The opposition leader requests a classified IMESI briefing — do we provide one (risking leaks) or refuse (appearing secretive)?
- Business associations are calling for withdrawal — do we engage them directly (risking "foreign interference" accusations) or let the government handle it?
- If parliament votes to suspend, do we invoke Continuity Despite Withdrawal or negotiate a face-saving "pause"?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Accession Impact Note delivered within 48 hours of parliamentary inquiry announcement
- ✓ Managed Adjustment accepted; coalition rebalances within 7 days; active case proceeds at >70% intensity
- ✓ Parliament votes to maintain participation after receiving non-partisan briefing
- ✓ Media narrative shifted from "GDP-tax" to "economic insurance" within 2 weeks
- ✓ Bilateral offer notified to Transparency Ledger; coalition aware of pressure campaign

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Accession Impact Note arrives after parliament has already voted; too late to influence debate
- ✗ Managed Adjustment invoked by this member triggers 2 additional members to invoke it; cascade effect
- ✗ Opposition briefing leaked to media; framed as "IMESI pressuring parliament" — backlash against membership
- ✗ Business associations' campaign succeeds; 60% public opinion against IMESI before any counter-narrative deployed
- ✗ Parliament suspends participation; remaining members' domestic opponents cite this as proof IMESI is failing

Primary References: Sections 3.1I, 3.2D, 4.3B+, 6.4B, 6.7A, 7.4B, 10A.6

SCENARIO 10

"THE COLLATERAL DAMAGE TRAP"

Testing Spillover Management and Neutral-Member Solidarity

THE INJECT

To punish IMESI Member A, a non-member superpower imposes a "Universal Port Blockade" on all vessels that have docked at Member A's ports in the last 60 days. This move inadvertently cripples the supply chains of three other IMESI members (B, C, D) who are neutral in the original dispute. Members B, C, and D face a choice: break solidarity with Member A to save their own trade, or face systemic disruption.

THE TWIST

The coercer offers Members B, C, and D "shipping lane exemptions" if they publicly distance themselves from Member A and vote against continued IMESI Phase 1 measures. The exemption requires only a "statement of neutrality" — not formal IMESI withdrawal. Members B and C are considering it because their consumer goods are stuck at sea.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can IMESI stabilise the "neutral" members fast enough to prevent a cascade of withdrawals driven by collateral economic pain?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 1.4/1.4B: GSD/SND — does the collateral impact on B, C, D constitute a separate systemic disruption?
- Section 8.11: Spillover Fund — can it subsidise increased shipping costs for neutral members?
- Section 8.11B: Non-Member Spillover — does this mechanism work for members harmed by coercion targeting another member?
- Section 8.9: Resilience Fund — can it fund emergency rerouting of shipping for Members B, C, D?
- Section 6.7A: Contained Non-Participation — if B or C accepts the "neutrality" offer, does the protocol activate?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Member C's trade minister calls: "Our ports are empty and our factories are shutting down. We need the exemption." What is your response?
- Do we file a separate GSD/SND case for the collateral damage, or handle it within the existing case against the coercer?
- The coercer's "neutrality statement" technically doesn't require IMESI withdrawal — can a member issue it without breaching obligations?
- Resilience Fund capacity is already partially committed to Member A's direct support — how do we allocate between direct target and collateral-damage members?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Resilience Fund emergency rerouting activated for Members B, C, D within 72 hours
- ✓ All four members maintain coalition participation
- ✓ Alternative shipping routes established within 14 days reducing losses to <15% of normal volume
- ✓ No member issues a "neutrality statement" — solidarity holds

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Resilience Fund insufficient to cover rerouting costs for 4 members simultaneously; prioritisation dispute erupts in CC
- ✗ Member C accepts "neutrality statement" exemption; Member D follows within 48 hours; coalition fragments
- ✗ "Neutrality statement" is ambiguous enough that issuing it doesn't technically breach IMESI obligations but destroys political credibility
- ✗ Collateral damage certification as GSD/SND takes >7 days; by then, factory shutdowns are irreversible

Primary References: Sections 1.4, 6.7A, 8.9, 8.11, 8.11B

SCENARIO 11

"THE SOVEREIGN EXIT"

Testing Withdrawal Continuity and Fund Resilience

THE INJECT

Following a change in government, a founding IMESI member — whose participation is critical for the swap-line network — announces they are triggering the withdrawal clause during the middle of an active Phase 1 crisis. The new government campaigned on "economic sovereignty" and considers IMESI a constraint imposed by the previous administration.

THE TWIST

The aggressor state in the active case immediately offers the departing member a massive "Stability Grant" (USD 5 billion over 3 years) to accelerate their exit and publicly denounce the IMESI activation. The departing member's central bank governor (a holdover from the previous government) opposes withdrawal but is overruled by the new finance minister.

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Can the remaining coalition rebalance the financial burden without the Fund collapsing? Does the departing member's swap-line capacity have a replacement?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Section 10A.6: Continuity Despite Withdrawal — does it actually prevent disruption to the active case?
- Section 4.6H: Swap Framework — can the network function with a major node missing?
- Section 8.0B: Contingent Continuity Band — does 10% cover the shortfall from a major contributor's exit?
- Section 4.6G: Multi-Host Distribution — does failover work when the departing member hosts a core function?
- Section 6.4B: Transparency Ledger — is the "Stability Grant" offer notified?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- The departing member hosts the SFI analytical centre — how do we maintain data continuity during the 24-month transition?
- The departing member's pre-withdrawal financial obligations (Section 10A.6) amount to USD 800M — will the new government honour them?
- Three other members' domestic opponents immediately cite the withdrawal as evidence IMESI is failing — how do we contain the narrative?
- The departing member's central bank governor offers to maintain swap-line access informally despite the political withdrawal — do we accept this legally ambiguous arrangement?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ Active case proceeds without interruption; remaining members cover departing member's share within 14 days
- ✓ Swap-line network reconfigured to alternative anchors within 30 days; no liquidity gap during transition
- ✓ SFI analytical centre data migrated to backup host within 48 hours via failover protocols
- ✓ No additional member announcements of withdrawal within 90 days
- ✓ Departing member's pre-withdrawal obligations enforced through standard dispute mechanisms

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ Contingent Continuity Band (10%) insufficient to cover a major contributor's sudden exit; emergency capital call required
- ✗ Swap-line reconfiguration takes >60 days; liquidity gap causes currency volatility in 2 smaller members
- ✗ SFI failover triggers but analytical data is partially corrupted; 72-hour gap in monitoring capability
- ✗ Two additional members announce "review of participation" within 30 days; cascade risk materialises
- ✗ New government refuses to honour pre-withdrawal obligations; no enforcement mechanism available beyond 24-month arbitration

Primary References: Sections 4.6G, 4.6H, 8.0B, 10A.6

SCENARIO 12

"THE STANDARDISATION BLOCKADE"

Testing Technical Coercion and Digital Market Exclusion

THE INJECT

A dominant tech power suddenly changes the mandatory encryption and data-compliance standards for all cross-border financial "handshakes." It provides the new software keys to everyone except IMESI members, claiming that IMESI's Transparency Ledger and shared intelligence protocols make member systems "inherently insecure" and incompatible with the new standard. This effectively "mutes" IMESI members in global digital markets — they cannot process financial transactions with any entity using the new standard.

THE TWIST

The tech power controls 65% of the global financial encryption infrastructure. Within 48 hours, IMESI members find that their banks cannot clear international transactions with any institution that has upgraded to the new standard. The tech power offers "individual compliance certificates" to any state that exits IMESI and submits to a bilateral "security audit."

RED TEAM OBJECTIVE

Does IMESI have a "technical off-ramp," or does the coalition get frozen out of the global financial system?

IMESI PROVISIONS UNDER TEST

- Annex 11B: Open Standards Protocol — can it activate an alternative encryption standard fast enough?
- Annex 11B+: Standards-Body Manipulation — does the deliberate exclusion qualify as coercion?
- Section 2.5D(f): Functional State-Adjoining Status — does the tech power's encryption monopoly qualify?
- Section 8.10Z: Digital Payment Playbooks — do members have alternative encryption/settlement capability?
- Section 5.0N: Flash Stabilisation — can emergency financial continuity be maintained for 7 days?
- Section 8.10+: SFI CBDC Coverage — can IMESI's own settlement infrastructure bypass the blocked standard?

DECISION POINTS FOR EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

- Banks cannot process international transactions — do we deploy SFI as an emergency parallel settlement system (massive cost) or negotiate individual compliance (breaking solidarity)?
- The tech power's "security concern" about IMESI has superficial technical merit — how do we counter it publicly?
- Three members' central banks are demanding emergency bilateral arrangements outside IMESI — do we allow it?
- The Open Standards Protocol specifies "soliciting alternatives" — but developing a new encryption standard takes months, not days. What do we do in the interim?
- Do we certify this as Functional State-Adjoining coercion (the tech company as state proxy) or as direct state coercion?

SUCCESS METRICS

- ✓ IEWC certifies within 48 hours: tech power's encryption monopoly qualifies as Functional State-Adjoining
- ✓ Flash Stabilisation activates SFI as emergency parallel settlement within 24 hours
- ✓ Open Standards Protocol identifies at least one interoperable alternative within 7 days
- ✓ No member accepts individual "compliance certificate" bilateral deal
- ✓ International settlement maintained at >60% of normal volume through SFI and alternative channels within 14 days

DOCUMENTED FAILURE MODES

- ✗ SFI capacity insufficient to handle full international settlement volume; system overwhelmed within 48 hours
- ✗ No alternative encryption standard exists at production-ready state; Open Standards Protocol solicitation returns nothing usable for 6+ months
- ✗ Three members accept "individual compliance certificates" because their banking sectors face insolvency within days
- ✗ Tech power's "security concern" gains traction with non-IMESI states; international consensus shifts against IMESI's position
- ✗ Functional State-Adjoining certification contested because the tech company is technically "private" despite 70% government ownership

Primary References: Sections 2.5D(f), 5.0N, 8.10+, 8.10Z, Annex 11B, 11B+

POST-EXERCISE INTEGRATION

Per Section 4.6I (Institutional Stress-Test and Red-Team Exercise), each completed scenario exercise shall produce:

- A 30-day lessons-learned report integrated into the IEWC scenario library.
- Identified provision gaps or ambiguities flagged for the next Coordination Committee review.
- Proposed amendments or operational procedure updates where failure modes are systemic.
- Updated calibration of Annex 24 (Operational Thresholds) where timing or capacity assumptions proved incorrect.
- A non-sensitive summary presented to the CC within 90 days, with Secretariat remediation steps.

This document is designed for use alongside IMESI v10.0 (234 pages) and the IMESI v10.0 Condensed (101 pages). Full provision text and section references correspond to the v10.0 framework.